

3.1 Unit description

Introduction

Coherence will be provided at A2 by the connection (chronological, geographical or thematic) between the depth study option taken in this unit and the Unit 4 programme of study determined by the teacher which should provide the context for the students' internally assessed work. Examples and guidance will be provided to centres in the Getting Started guide.

Each depth study in this unit allows students to explore issues of challenge and conflict within societies and systems and the impact those challenges and conflicts had in the period studied.

Students should undertake a study in some depth and at a more demanding level than that which is required in Unit 2. Students gain a firm understanding of both the selected chronology and the key issues, problems and debates associated with the selected topic. Each of these depth studies enables students to explore the nature of challenges and conflict, both within the period and relating to the societies and/or political systems studied. Students demonstrate their understanding in a written examination by answering an essay question requiring them to reach a developed and substantiated judgement.

The unit also enables students to work with secondary sources selected to provide evidence of differing views about defined associated historical controversies. Making use of evidence skills developed in Unit 2 and elsewhere, students should reach judgements grounded in their knowledge of the relevant historical issues and of the overall context, by use of analysis, cross-referencing and evaluation of historical claims.